WELCOME TO SITGURU

Growth Manager Onboarding Handbook

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Trusted Pet Care. Simplified.

Operational guide - your Independent Contractor Services Agreement remains the governing engagement document.

Welcome to SitGuru

Ava, welcome to SitGuru. You are joining at a stage where your ideas, judgment, and leadership can materially shape how people discover, trust, and participate in the SitGuru community.

Your role is broader than managing social posts. You are empowered to help build the system that grows SitGuru across digital channels, local communities, events, partnerships, Ambassador activity, market learning, and the intern team you lead.

> **Your operating principle**
>
> You do not need to wait for Jason to tell you how to solve every routine growth problem. Understand the objective and guardrails, use your professional judgment, test ideas thoughtfully, measure the outcome, and bring forward what you learn.

What success looks like

- Pet Parents, Gurus, and Ambassadors increasingly discover and engage with SitGuru.
- Community events and local outreach become repeatable acquisition channels rather than one-off appearances.
- The Ambassador program develops into a practical in-person and remote growth channel.
- Surveys, polls, interviews, and experiments produce useful market learning that changes what SitGuru does next.
- Assigned interns receive meaningful, creative work that advances their syllabus and final project.
- You build systems, playbooks, and habits that make SitGuru better at growth over time - not just busier.

What You Own

Workstream	Your ownership
Social & Content	Lead organic social strategy, content direction, editorial priorities, creative testing, community engagement, and routine content readiness.
Community Growth	Develop direct community-growth plans that turn awareness into Pet Parent, Guru, Ambassador, and partner participation.
Events	Plan SitGuru event activations - tent/display experience, messaging, QR/sign-up flow, team roles, lead capture, follow-up, and lessons learned.
Ambassador Growth	Develop and test a hybrid Ambassador program that can work person-to-person and remotely/digitally.
Growth Intelligence	Use surveys, polls, interviews, event feedback, social tests, and other research to understand the market and recommend action.

Workstream	Your ownership
Intern Leadership	Lead assigned interns day to day: priorities, coaching, creative feedback, review, development, and syllabus/final-project alignment.
Growth Learning	Use the SitGuru Growth Workspace and approved analytics to separate activity from business outcomes, identify what worked, and recommend what comes next.

Your Decision Rights

Ava decides	Align / keep Jason informed	Jason approval required
Routine organic content and creative direction; intern assignments; routine project priorities; surveys/polls; event activation planning; routine community outreach planning; routine growth experiments within approved resources.	Material change in campaign direction; meaningful new resource need; elevated reputational risk; proposed partnership worth executive awareness; experiment likely to affect broader company strategy.	Paid advertising or substantial spend; contracts; binding partnership commitments; compensation/personnel decisions; legal/policy statements; major company-wide brand changes; sensitive public issues; formal university/employer approvals.

When in doubt

If the decision is routine, reversible, within approved resources, and does not create legal, financial, contractual, personnel, or significant reputational exposure, you should usually be able to move it forward. If the decision commits SitGuru externally or materially changes risk, bring Jason in.

How We Work

System	Use it for
SitGuru Messaging	Primary day-to-day internal operational messaging and authorized Pet Parent, Guru, Ambassador, Partner, and other community communication. Use Internal Notes for team-only context and follow role-based reporting/escalation rules.

System	Use it for
Microsoft Teams	Meetings, video calls, screen sharing, collaborative working sessions, and Microsoft-based team collaboration. Routine operational chat belongs in SitGuru Messaging.
Microsoft Planner	The source of truth for work: your projects, intern assignments, owners, priorities, deadlines, review, approval, and Results & Learning.
SharePoint	Official shared team files, reusable assets, reports, research, event materials, and team documents.
OneDrive	Personal working files and drafts.
Canva	Creative production using approved SitGuru brand standards.
SitGuru Growth Workspace	Business outcomes: growth metrics, campaigns, events, Ambassador performance, surveys/tests, insights, and recommendations.
Intern Portal	Formal internship record: hours, evidence, weekly reporting, syllabus milestones, KPI claims, and final-project progress.
Manager Desk	Your formal view of the interns assigned to you.
Admin Portal	Founder/Admin access and role administration. This is not your general workspace.

Simple rule

SitGuru Messaging = operational/community communication. Teams = meetings and collaborative sessions. Planner = manage the work. Growth Workspace = measure growth. Intern Portal = document the internship. Manager Desk = oversee assigned interns.

The SitGuru Operating Technology Stack

SitGuru uses a connected set of company and third-party systems. You do not need to force every activity into one platform. The goal is to use the right system for the right job and keep one clear source of truth for each kind of information.

Stack principle

Use SitGuru Messaging for routine operational and community communication. Use Teams for meetings, video calls, screen sharing, and collaborative working sessions. Manage executable work in Planner. Keep official shared files in SharePoint. Build creative in Canva or another approved creative tool. Measure business outcomes in the Growth Workspace. Manage internship learning in the Intern Portal. Record official time in SitGuru Timekeeper when enabled.

Core operating stack

Layer	System / Tool	Primary purpose / source of truth
Operational & community messaging	SitGuru Messaging	Primary company-controlled chat for internal Growth Team work and authorized community conversations. Use role-based permissions, Internal Notes, reporting/escalation, and professional communication standards.
Collaboration	**Microsoft Teams**	Meetings, video calls, screen sharing, collaborative sessions, and Microsoft-based working context. Routine operational chat belongs in SitGuru Messaging.
Work management	**Microsoft Planner**	Source of truth for executable work: projects, assignments, owners, priorities, due dates, review stages, and results/learning follow-up.
Shared files	**SharePoint**	Official team files, approved documents, shared references, reusable assets, and materials the team needs to find again.
Individual drafts	**OneDrive**	Personal working files and drafts before they become official team materials. Move/share final team records through the approved shared location.
Email & calendar	**Outlook / Calendar**	Formal external or internal email, scheduled meetings, calendar invitations, and time-based commitments.

Layer	System / Tool	Primary purpose / source of truth
Creative production	**Canva + approved creative tools**	Graphics, social assets, presentations, short-form creative, brand templates, and other approved production workflows.
Growth operations	**SitGuru Growth Workspace**	Business growth source of truth: campaigns, community/events, Ambassador initiatives, experiments, results, learning, KPIs, and recommendations.
Intern management	**SitGuru Manager Desk**	Assigned-intern oversight: development, workload/capacity, review queues, syllabus progress, time review, and coaching visibility.
Internship records	**SitGuru Intern Portal**	Academic internship system of record: weekly reports, evidence, university requirements, milestones, final-project progress, and formal internship documentation.
Timekeeping	**SitGuru Timekeeper**	Official time record for the Growth Manager and interns once enabled. Intern planning/actual hours flow through manager review and Founder approval; Growth Manager time flows to Founder approval for invoice support.
Administration	**SitGuru Admin Portal**	Role assignments, access control, approved configuration, Founder/Admin oversight, and other restricted administrative functions.
Platform data	**SitGuru platform/admin data**	Authoritative SitGuru business data such as registrations, bookings, referrals, events, user/market activity, and other product records available to your role.
Measurement	**GA4, Search Console, native social analytics, Mailchimp, and other approved analytics sources**	Measurement and verification as applicable. Use authoritative sources and approved tracking methods; do not overstate attribution.
Public channels	**Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, X, YouTube, and other approved channels**	Publishing, engagement, community interaction, and audience development under SitGuru brand and access rules.

Layer	System / Tool	Primary purpose / source of truth
AI & specialty tools	**Other SitGuru-approved AI, research, survey, event, CRM/community, automation, analytics, and creative software**	Support work where useful and approved. Tool approval never overrides data-security, access, human-review, brand, or decision-right requirements.

How to choose where something belongs

- If it is routine operational conversation, use SitGuru Messaging. Use Teams for meetings, video calls, screen sharing, and collaborative working sessions.
- If someone needs to do it, assign or track it in Planner.
- If it is an official team file, put it in SharePoint rather than leaving the only copy in a personal folder or chat.
- If it is a growth result, campaign learning, event result, or recommendation, capture it in the Growth Workspace.
- If it is an intern academic record, evidence item, syllabus milestone, weekly report, or final-project record, use the Intern Portal.
- If it is official time worked, use SitGuru Timekeeper when enabled; do not make Planner or Teams the official timesheet.
- If a new system would materially improve the work, propose it. Do not create a new source of truth simply because another tool is convenient.

The stack will evolve. Current products are not a closed list. Follow the Approved Systems & Software policy and the access provided to your role. If SitGuru replaces a tool, the business purpose and source-of-truth rule should remain clear even when the software changes.

SitGuru Messaging & Community Communications

SitGuru Messaging is the primary day-to-day operational communication channel for the Growth Team and the preferred company-controlled channel for authorized communication with Pet Parents, Gurus, Ambassadors, Partners, and other approved community contacts.

- Your official company identity is Ava Venezia | Social Media & Community Growth Manager | ava@sitguru.com | ava@sitguru.com.
- Use Teams primarily for scheduled meetings, video calls, screen sharing, and collaborative working sessions. Do not duplicate routine operational chat across Teams and SitGuru Messaging.
- Keep assignments, owners, due dates, approvals, academic records, official time, and business results in their designated systems of record. Chat provides context; it is not the source of truth for everything.

Community-facing communication

You may communicate in an official SitGuru capacity with authorized Pet Parents, Gurus, Ambassadors, Partners, and community contacts within your role and approved campaign/relationship boundaries.

- Use Internal Notes for team-only context. Confirm you are in the correct message mode before posting; internal notes must never be exposed to the community participant.

- Do not make unauthorized legal, financial, refund, contractual, employment, partnership, policy, or safety guarantees.

Intern messaging supervision

Interns receive role-appropriate messaging permissions rather than unrestricted access. Early-stage interns may draft or reply only to assigned conversations; later-stage interns may earn greater independence within approved audiences and guardrails.

- Coach tone, accuracy, privacy, authority boundaries, and professional judgment. Increase independence when the intern demonstrates sound judgment rather than requiring permanent review of every message.
- Official intern outreach should remain in SitGuru Messaging or another specifically approved company channel rather than personal text, personal email, WhatsApp, or personal social DMs.

Professional conduct, reporting & monitoring

SitGuru messaging systems are company systems. Communications may be retained, logged, reviewed, or audited by specifically authorized administrators for legitimate operational, safety, security, professional-conduct, compliance, investigation, trust-and-safety, or legal purposes, subject to applicable law and policy.

- Report or escalate harassment, threats, discrimination, sexual/inappropriate content, scams, credential/payment exposure, serious privacy issues, safety concerns, or other significant conduct concerns. If a report involves you, it should route to Founder/Admin rather than depend on your review.
- Do not use company messaging for personal conversations you expect to remain private, and never place passwords, API keys, bank/tax information, payment-card data, or restricted personnel information in ordinary chat.
- Read and follow the separate SitGuru Communications & Messaging Policy and User Guide. Material policy changes may require re-acknowledgment.

Communication & Meeting Rhythm

Weekly Growth Meeting - you lead it

The team meeting should be collaborative and useful, not a status-reading exercise. Use Planner for visibility so meeting time can focus on decisions, learning, blockers, and ideas.

Segment	Purpose
Wins & learning	What moved, what surprised us, and what did we learn?
Growth picture	Pet Parent/Guru/Ambassador movement, campaigns, events, or notable market signals.
Current work	What is in progress, what needs review, and what is blocked?

Segment	Purpose
Intern development	Quick progress view without turning the meeting into individual performance review.
Creative Lab	Make space for you and the interns to propose experiments, campaigns, event ideas, content directions, and community-growth opportunities.
Close	Confirm owners, next actions, and any item requiring Jason.

Jason + Ava Growth & Leadership 1:1

- Growth performance and what you think it means.
- Your priorities and workload.
- Intern development, syllabus progress, and final-project direction.
- Decisions or resources you need from Jason.
- Risks, sensitive issues, or items that should stay in leadership discussion.
- What you want to test or change next.

Intern 1:1 / coaching conversations

Use short individual conversations when useful to understand development, not just task status. Ask what they are learning, what they want to try, where they are stuck, and what they want to own next.

Leading Interns Creatively

Your job as intern leader

Your job is not to have all the ideas. Your job is to create an environment where good ideas emerge, help interns turn those ideas into strong work, and make sure SitGuru learns from the results.

Creative freedom levels

Level	How to use it
Explore	Give the business problem and guardrails. The intern researches and proposes the approach.
Guided	Define the objective, audience, and boundaries. The intern owns the creative execution.
Directed	Use when a specific company, compliance, academic, deadline, or approved-output requirement must be followed exactly.

Default expectation: most meaningful internship work should be Explore or Guided. Directed work is appropriate when the requirement genuinely needs it.

Coach the thinking, not just the output

- What problem are you trying to solve?
- Who is the audience and what do you think they need?
- What is your hypothesis or reasoning?
- How would we know if this worked?
- What evidence will we retain?
- What did you learn - especially if the result was not what you expected?
- What should SitGuru do next?

Syllabus & Final-Project Alignment

The Spring 2027 employer syllabus remains the learning roadmap for the interns. Your role is to help them accomplish those requirements through authentic SitGuru work while keeping the final Market Growth Project in view from the beginning.

Timing	Syllabus focus	Your coaching emphasis
Weeks 1-2	Market definition, audience research, baseline metrics, risks/opportunities, SMART targets.	Teach context, ask questions, and help the intern form an evidence-based starting point.
Weeks 3-5	Audience strategy, content pillars, channel plan, editorial calendar, tracking system, creative templates.	Shift to guided design. Ask the intern to propose the strategy and explain the reasoning.
Weeks 6-11	Campaigns, experiments, partner/community work, KPI tracking, evidence, optimization.	Increase autonomy. Require hypotheses, measurement, reflection, and next-step recommendations.
Weeks 12-14	Winning channels, repeatable tactics, SOPs, templates, asset library, recommendations.	Help convert semester learning into reusable systems SitGuru can keep using.
Week 15	Verified metrics, findings, recommendations, final presentation, portfolio version.	Coach synthesis and storytelling: problem -> strategy -> evidence -> results -> learning -> recommendation.

Every meaningful Planner assignment should connect to

- A SitGuru business objective.
- A syllabus or learning component.
- Evidence that can be retained in the Intern Portal.
- A possible contribution to the final Market Growth Project, Playbook, Business Growth Report, portfolio case study, or final presentation.

Formal boundary

You may lead and coach the internship day to day. Jason remains the employer supervisor of record unless a university-approved arrangement explicitly changes that. Formal university documentation, required employer evaluations, and official employer-level academic approvals remain with the supervisor of record.

Community Growth in Practice

Event activation

Treat an event as a measurable community-growth channel, not just a table and flyers. The experience should help people understand SitGuru, engage naturally, and take a trackable next step.

- Define the event objective and target audiences.
- Plan the tent/display experience, messaging, QR/sign-up flow, materials, and team roles.
- Use appropriate tracking so event leads and registrations can be distinguished from other sources.
- Capture Pet Parent, Guru, and Ambassador interest without collecting unnecessary personal information.
- Record results, follow-ups, lessons learned, and what should change next time.

Ambassador development

Develop the Ambassador program as a hybrid growth channel: in-person/community Ambassadors and remote/digital Ambassadors. Start with pilots, give Ambassadors practical tools, track referrals or other approved outcomes, and improve the program based on evidence.

Growth Intelligence

Use surveys, polls, interviews, event feedback, social tests, A/B tests, and other lightweight research to answer real growth questions. Do not collect opinions just to have data - connect each test to a decision SitGuru may make.

> **Growth Intelligence sequence**
>
> Test -> Learn -> Recommend -> Act -> Measure.

Measure Learning, Not Just Activity

Posts, videos, reach, views, and followers can be useful activity signals, but SitGuru also cares about business outcomes such as registrations, referrals, event conversions, partners, and other verified growth results. Keep those categories separate.

- Do not claim attribution unless an approved tracking or verification method supports it.
- Document experiments that do not succeed. A failed test can be valuable when the reasoning, evidence, learning, and next action are strong.
- Use the Growth Workspace for business outcomes and decision support; use Planner for the work required to produce those outcomes.
- Your recommendation should answer: What happened? Why might it have happened? What did we learn? What should we try next?

Your First 30 Days

Timing	Focus	Expected outcome
Days 1-3	Learn SitGuru, systems, users, current social/community presence, existing assets, and intern program.	You understand the business well enough to ask better questions.
Days 4-10	Conduct a fresh Growth Discovery: customer journey, social audit, Pet Parent opportunities, events, Ambassador ideas, and first market questions.	Initial SitGuru Growth Assessment.
Days 11-14	Prioritize what should be tested first and decide what you will own versus delegate.	30-Day Growth Plan and initial Planner work.
Weeks 3-4	Execute at least one meaningful growth test, begin establishing operating rhythm, and start using results to adjust strategy.	SitGuru is learning through action, not remaining in planning mode.
Day 30	Review what moved, what you learned, what you want to change, and what you need from Jason.	Clear next-phase priorities and increased ownership.

Your first major deliverable

SitGuru 30-Day Growth Plan

Bring forward your top priorities, Pet Parent growth approach, social priorities, community/event opportunities, Ambassador pilot idea, first market test, how the intern team can support the work, and what you need from Jason.

Access, Security & Professional Boundaries

- Use only the systems and permissions provided to your role; do not seek or share Admin, customer, payment, tax, or security access you do not need.
- Use individual credentials and MFA where supported; do not share passwords.
- Keep customer and Pet Parent PII out of intern work, portfolio materials, unapproved AI tools, and public content.
- Use official SitGuru brand assets and approved public information.
- Do not make binding commitments, contracts, paid-media commitments, or legal/policy statements on SitGuru's behalf without appropriate approval.
- This handbook is operational guidance and does not replace or modify your Independent Contractor Services Agreement.

Approved Systems & Software

The systems named in this handbook are examples of SitGuru's current operating environment, not an exclusive list. You may use other SitGuru-approved systems, software, platforms, applications, or services when they are authorized for your role, project, or task. This may include approved communication and collaboration tools, project-management tools, creative and editing software, analytics platforms, survey/research tools, social-media tools, event tools, productivity software, automation tools, CRM or community-growth tools, and AI-assisted tools.

- Use only tools that SitGuru has approved for the applicable work. Approval may be standing, role-based, project-specific, or task-specific.
- A newly approved tool does not expand your authority or data access. Continue to use least-privilege access and only the information needed for the work.
- Do not place customer/Pet Parent PII, passwords, payment information, security credentials, confidential company information, or restricted intern/personnel information into an external or AI-assisted tool unless SitGuru has specifically approved that use and data handling.
- If you identify a tool that could improve growth, creativity, analytics, events, surveys, Ambassador work, or team operations, recommend it to Jason for approval rather than assuming it is permitted.

Getting Started Checklist

☐ Independent Contractor Services Agreement completed.

☐ W-9 / payment onboarding completed through the approved process.

☐ SitGuru account and Growth Manager role active.

☐ Microsoft Teams access active.

☐ Planner access active.

☐ SharePoint/team files access active.

☐ Canva/brand access active.

☐ Approved social-platform access active.

☐ Growth Workspace access active.

☐ Manager Desk access active for assigned interns.

☐ Spring 2027 Internship Syllabus reviewed.

☐ Intern Portal User Guide reviewed.

☐ Founder kickoff completed.

☐ First Growth Discovery project created in Planner.

☐ Official SitGuru email / Microsoft 365 account active: ava@sitguru.com.

☐ SitGuru Messaging access active and Communications & Messaging Policy reviewed.

Final note

Bring your ideas. Challenge assumptions respectfully. Use evidence. Help the interns grow. Keep SitGuru learning. That is the role.